ALAA RIFAT

Writer | Language Editor | Trainer | Cultural Project Manager

Jeddah, Saudi Arabia Phone: +966 56 581 4391 Email: alaa.rifat@refaahgroup.co.uk Website:alaarifat.com

LinkedIn:alaa-rifat

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder and Director
2024 – Present

Refaah Group Ltd. | London, United Kingdom

- Founded Refaah Group as a parent company encompassing Alaa Rifat Professional Language Services Office and Refaah Academy for Creativity, Development and Education.

Founder and Director
2024 – Present

Refaah Academy for Creativity, Development and Education | Cairo, Egypt

- Established the academy to develop educational and creative initiatives, organise workshops and cultural events, and create opportunities for learning and knowledge exchange.

Founder and Director
2023 – Present

Alaa Rifat Professional Language Services Office

- Established the office to provide proofreading, editing, translation and content development services, and to oversee language-related projects and coordinate work with specialists.

Language Editor and Proofreader
2023 – 2024

Wasm Publications | Kuwait

- Collaborated on proofreading and editing projects.

Language Editor and Proofreader
2022 – 2023

Al-Fa'al Cultural Foundation | Khartoum, Sudan

- Collaborated on proofreading and editing projects.

Language Editor and Proofreader
2021 – 2022

Nartaqi Publishing and Distribution House | Khartoum, Sudan

- Collaborated on proofreading and editing projects.

Freelance Language Editor and Proofreader
2016 – Present

- Providing proofreading and editing services since 2016, working on literary, cultural and media manuscripts and texts, alongside writing and content development.

CULTURAL PROJECTS AND INITIATIVES

The Story with Alaa Rifat
April 2025 – April 2026

- Founder, presenter and principal interviewer of a documentary interview project exploring the stories and experiences of Arabic-speaking creatives, with a focus on Sudan, Egypt and Chad. First season released in April 2025, second season in April 2026.

SudanBridge – Mentor, Mentoring Programme
Sep – Dec 2026

- Served as a mentor in the programme's first cohort from September to December 2026, and participated in a SudanBridge seminar.
- Programme: sultan-hassan.github.io/mentoring_program | Seminar: youtube.com/live/efQOfU2Fi0c

Proofreading Skills Workshops

- Delivered more than 15 editions of proofreading skills workshops and conducted the first specialised proofreading skills workshop in Sudan.

Editing and Proofreading Projects

- Proofread and edited more than 500 manuscripts and texts across a range of literary, cultural and media fields.

TRAINING AND PROFESSIONAL ENGAGEMENTS

- Delivered Language Skills for Journalists – Fourth Edition, in collaboration with the International Union of Press and Media and Andaleeb Publications, 2025.
- Delivered Language for Everyone, in collaboration with the Literary Partner initiative, Makkah, 2025.
- Delivered Enhancing Writers' Written Expression, organised by Bayt Al-Kateb Foundation, Jeddah, July 2024.
- Organised and hosted the monthly Ask a Writer series via Zoom, July–November 2024.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Anesthesia and Resuscitation Technology 2016
Al-Ribat National University, Khartoum, Sudan

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- E-Learning and Training Specialist Programme – Arab Board for Consultancy and Training, in coordination with New Visions International, 30 hours, Dec 2025 – Jan 2026.
- Anta Literary Editing Programme – Literature, Publishing and Translation Commission, 40 hours, 2025.
- Grammatical Reflection on the Holy Qur'an Workshop – Al-Burhan Academy, 2025.
- Naqid 3 Intensive Literary Criticism Programme – Saudi Association for Comparative Literature, 60 hours, 2024.
- The Impact of Artificial Intelligence on Jobs Workshop – Misk Career Preparation Programme, 2024.
- Arab Board Certificate in Proofreading Skills – Consultancy and Development Foundation, Cairo, February 2021.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- "The Anthropology of the World of Proofreaders" – Kitabh Platform, November 2026. (kitabh.com/p/6aead91a102ff62418ba6ca6)
- "Voice of the Earth: On Art as a Form of Belonging" – The Purple Fox Magazine, September 2026. Published in Arabic, English and French. (thepurplefoxfr.com/d/21r)
- "A Simple Mission" – In an anthology of African short stories, compiled by novelist Abdelaziz Baraka Sakin, 2025.
- "The Theme of Escape in Mohamed Kordofani's Goodbye Julia: A Feminist Study" – Saudi Criticism Lab; final graduation project for the Naqid 3 programme, 2024.
- "Maryam as She Walks into the Distance" – Medameek online newspaper, 2021. (medameek.com/?p=51958)

AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

- Recommendation from the UAE Ministry of Culture for the Golden Residency under the category of creative professionals in culture and the arts, August 2025.
- Appreciation Award, Tayeb Salih Short Story Award for Young Writers, for "Maryam as She Walks into the Distance", 2021.
- Appreciation Award in Flash Fiction, Kotobia Literary Award, 2021.

LANGUAGES

Arabic: Native | **English:** Advanced